

This gives you an edge as it allows you to easily showcase your work results. And if lucky, your open source work can help you skip past some of the tricky parts of interviews upon selection for a tech job.

A few ground rules before you make your first contribution

1. Don't fear making your first contribution. You don't have to be an expert to begin.
2. Even if you haven't written a line of code in your entire life, there are still different ways to contribute to open source. You don't necessarily have to learn to code.
3. You don't need to ask anyone's permission before contributing to an open source project. But it's nice to chat with the project maintenance team to have a better chance of your contribution being accepted.
4. Always start small rather than making a big contribution. If you don't know the people maintaining the project, their purpose for the project and their expectations from your contribution, chances are your contribution will get rejected. You'll get less frustrated if you decide to work small instead of working big for several weeks, only to get refused later.
5. Never give up if your first try doesn't work out. Learn from the feedback on your contribution and make relevant improvements to your style of work. Your contribution will surely get accepted next time.

Steps to make your first open source contribution

Choose a project: If you don't know where to start, then there are a few different open source tools you can use.

One of them is a website called *First Contributions*, where you can find a lot of open source projects with specific issues that are friendly for first-time contributions. Simply go through them and select.

On selecting a project, you will be taken to the GitHub page of the project and into the *Issues* section, which is filtered with good first issues for first-time contributors (Figure 2).

Go through the different issues and select the one that interests you.

After selecting the issue, read the general description to know what you are expected to do. If someone has

already assigned himself/herself to the project, then look for any other issue to work upon.

If you don't wish to go through GitHub, then there is another method, for which Node.js should be installed in your machine. Type `npx good-first-issue` in the terminal and it will give you a list of available projects (Figure 4).

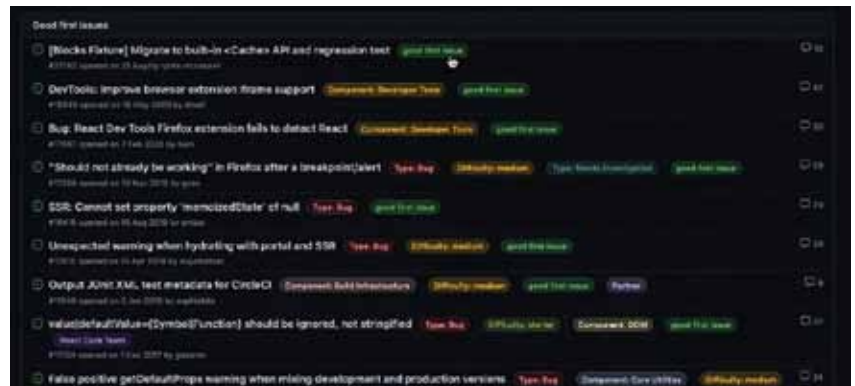


Figure 2: Screenshot of the GitHub page showing different good first issues (Credit: OSI 2021)

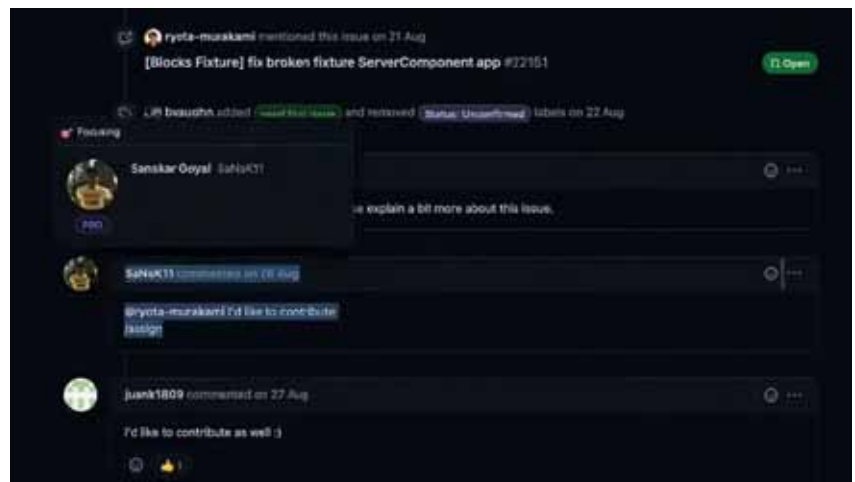


Figure 3: Screenshot showing a user who is already assigned to an issue (Credit: OSI 2021)

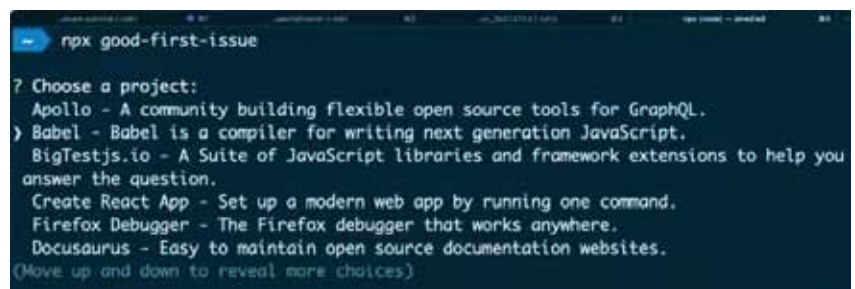


Figure 4: Command type and project selection options